

Write It: The Danger Dice

Roll a danger, then write it. Trigger, Reaction, Pause, Sting.

ACTIVITY 3 from the class textbook

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Write a piece for your school newspaper or magazine in which you describe, in the first person, a dangerous experience that happened to you (real or imagined). Aim to write around 200 words and try to sustain a sense of drama or danger throughout your piece. If possible, you might also like to include the second person (you).

THE FOUR MOVES

Trigger a sound or sight opens it

Reaction body, feeling and thought

Pause a thought or a “you” aside

Sting end with the danger alive

BANNED scary, very, really, loud, suddenly

PART A • DO NOW

5 min • alone

- A1** Which kind of danger word? *my stomach dropped*
A2 Rewrite in the third person: *I held my breath and my hands shook.*
A3 First person makes me feel _____ because _____.

PART B • THE DANGER DICE

12 min • pairs • score points

How to play. Roll or pick a number 1 to 6 on each list. Write ONE trigger sentence that opens with the sound. Your partner scores it. Three rounds. Maximum 12.

Where 1 frozen lake 2 rope bridge 3 dark cave 4 river crossing 5 climbing wall 6 rowing boat

What goes wrong 1 weather turns 2 kit fails 3 separated 4 ground gives way 5 light runs out 6 something breaks

Sound 1 crack 2 snap 3 hiss 4 rumble 5 click 6 silence

Score each sentence. +1 opens on the sound +1 something specific, such as a simile +1 no banned words +1 first person.

PART C • THE DRILL

13 min • alone • easy to hard

- C1 Strongest trigger.** Which opening is best, and why? (a) *There was a loud noise.* (b) *The cable gave one dry click.* (c) *Suddenly something happened.*
C2 Body. Rewrite using a body detail: *I was scared.*
C3 Thought. Write a question the narrator asks themselves on a frozen lake.
C4 Short sentence. Turn this into a blunt sentence: *I was so frightened that I could not move at all.*
C5 You aside. Write ONE “you” sentence for the Pause of a rope-bridge piece.
C6 Sting. Which ending keeps the danger alive, and why? (a) *Then I was safe.* (b) *The second strand snapped.* (c) *It was just a dream.*
C7 Doctor the person. Fix: *I stepped onto the ice and she heard a crack.*
C8 Headline. Write a headline for a magazine piece about the cave, and say why it works.

PART D • EXIT TICKET

6 min • alone • 4 marks

Write the Sting: the last two sentences of a piece about a rope bridge. Marks: 1 first person 2 a new sound or sight 3 a threat 4 danger left unresolved.